

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 4

♥ Q 7 6

♦ Q 10 9 6

♣ A 8 5

♠ A Q 8 6 2

♥ J 5 3

♦ 7 4

♣ K Q 2



♠ 5

♥ A K 10 9

♦ J 8 3 2

♣ 10 9 4 3

♠ K 9 7 3

♥ 8 4 2

♦ A K 5

♣ J 7 6

SOUTH has just 11 points, not enough to open the bidding. But when NORTH opens 1♠ SOUTH should show her "almost opening strength" by jumping to 3♠.

NORTH has just 13 points, and knowing SOUTH has less than 13 he passes.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

1♠

Pass

3♠

All Pass

3♠ by North

Lead: ♥K

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q J 4
 ♥ 10
 ♦ J 10 7 4 3
 ♣ 10 8 4

♠ 7 3

♥ Q 8 6 4 2

♦ A 8 6

♣ K 9 5



♠ A 9 6 5

♥ J 9

♦ 9 2

♣ A J 7 3 2

♠ 10 8 2

♥ A K 7 5 3

♦ K Q 5

♣ Q 6

After SOUTH opens with 1♥, NORTH has a small "dilemma". With 11 points she really is only strong enough to make a jump raise to 3♥. But, with five trumps the hand deserves more. So she just bids 4♥ instead.

Usually, no matter what your strength, when you have five cards in the Major suit that your partner opens with you should just jump right to game.

*West**North**East**South*

1♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♠K

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 6 2
♥ 9 8 5 4
♦ J 7 5
♣ 9 8 5

♠ K 10 8 3

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 8 6

♣ Q J 3



♠ 9 4

♥ K Q 10 6 3

♦ 10 4 2

♣ A 7 4

♠ Q J 7 5

♥ A

♦ A K Q 3

♣ K 10 6 2

SOUTH has 19 points, but no 5-card Major suit.
With two 4-card minor suits she should start with
1♦.

NORTH has a poor hand, but with 7 points he must
respond. His first priority is to show a Major suit so
he responds 1♠.

SOUTH now knows that ♠s will be trumps, so she
revalues her hand to 21 points, enough for game. She
bids 4♠.

West	North	East	South
			1♦
Pass	1♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♥K			

Board 4

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 2
♥ 10 6 3
♦ 10 9 4 3 2
♣ J 10 2

♠ 10 9 6 3

♥ 7 5 4

♦ Q 7

♣ A K 6 4



♠ A 5

♥ A J 9 8

♦ K 8 5

♣ Q 8 7 5

♠ K Q J 7 4

♥ K Q 2

♦ A J 6

♣ 9 3

NOTE: There is a better way to bid this hand using special conventions.

SOUTH has 17 points, but with a 5-card Major opens 1♠ rather than 1NT. NORTH isn't quite strong enough for a jump raise, so she bids 2♠. SOUTH has enough extra to make a try for game, so she invites with 3♠. NORTH has enough extra to accept the invitation, bids 4♠.

West	North	East	South
			1♠
Pass	2♠	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♣J			